

ASML Holding (ASML.AS): Catalyst rich 2026 bodes well for path to €1600/share, stock underprices key value drivers; reiterate Buy

EUROPE TECHNOLOGY: HARDWARE

Analysing the role of European AI enablers and updating our view on long-term upside potential

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Following our [reiteration note](#) on ASML five months ago, where we highlighted a path to a €1,200 share price, we reiterate our Buy rating on the name again, with the shares now trading above that level. Importantly, we note positive developments across multiple upside drivers identified in that report and believe the shares are favourably positioned to see another leg of upside in the coming quarters. We continue to frame ASML's fundamental value around four core variables: 1) AI demand growth, 2) China revenue exposure, 3) customer market structure driven manufacturing inefficiencies, and 4) EUV Lithography layer growth. In this report, we refresh our analytical framework to reflect positive datapoints on leading-edge semis demand and our US semis team's updated view on a higher WFE spending versus prior expectations (discussed in detail below), assess what the market is currently pricing for each variable of our fundamental value framework across different share price scenarios, and outline an updated catalyst pathway. We also contextualise valuation by comparing ASML's 2Y P/E multiple with global semiconductor capital equipment peers and note that while ASML has historically traded at a premium of c.20% to peers, it now trades at a slight discount — a valuation we view as unjustified given accelerating AI related growth, increasing exposure to leading edge memory (where ASML has a greater exposure versus other European semicaps), and strengthening competitive moat (as EUV increases in the mix). We reiterate our Buy rating and raise our 12M PT to €1,600 (vs €1,570 prior).

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We continue to see upside risk as the share price does not, in our view, fully reflect the likely outcomes across the four pillars of our investment thesis, particularly in light of encouraging recent datapoints

Since our December report, where we identified the key areas of investor focus for ASML, **we have seen constructive updates across multiple drivers of our thesis and expect these factors to remain influential** for share price performance over the coming quarters given scope for further upgrades to expectations on each. As such, the four pillars of our ASML thesis remain unchanged: 1) **AI demand growth**, 2) **China revenue exposure**, 3) **customer market structure driven manufacturing inefficiencies**, and 4) **EUV Lithography layer growth**. Notably, **AI related demand has exceeded prior expectations**, supported by increased hyperscaler capex plans and more constructive commentary around **capacity expansion from leading edge logic/foundry and memory players**. Below, we update our ASML framework to show what assumptions appear embedded in the current share price, those implied at the trough in a bear case scenario, as well as those underpinning our 12 month price target and 2027 bull case scenario. More broadly, **we believe the current share price still reflects relatively conservative outlook on most of the assumptions** (shown in [Exhibit 1](#)) across the four key variables, despite some improvement in investor sentiment on selected metrics, and we see a positive risk reward skew.

Exhibit 1: While ASML has re-rated over the last six months, we continue to see a favourable 2x risk-reward skew

Key 2027 KPIs for ASML at various valuations

Key components of ASML thesis	Bear Case	Last Close	GS 12M PT	Bull Case	Comments
AI share of ASML's EUV revenues, %	High Teens %	Mid-20s %	High-20s %	mid-30s %	
Implied WFE market size (in \$bn)	144	169	186	195	WFE market is expected to be c.\$186bn in 2027 (per GSe)
EUV layers added in 2027 vs 2025					Increase in chip design complexity, driving EUV layer count increase
Logic	+2	+3	+4	+5	Logic EUV layers 25-30 by 2030; vs 19-21 in 2025 (per ASML)
Memory	+2	+2	+3	+3	Memory EUV layers 7-10 by 2030; vs 5 in 2025 (per ASML)
Market Structure inefficiency factor, %	5%	7%	8%	8%	Increased customer competition drives up metric; Guidance: 5-8%
China revenue share, %	17%	18%	19%	20%	Historic range is 15-20%; Guidance c.20% in CY26
ASML stock price per share, €	921	1,325	1,600	2,000	
Upside/Downside, %	-30%	0%	21%	52%	
Premium/Discount vs Global semicap peers	-19%	0%	9%	22%	
Percentile vs. last 5Y Premium/Discount	1st	10th	30th	60th	

1. EUV layers represents both High and Low NA layers 2. GS WFE estimates grow +28%/32% in 2026/27 (in \$ terms), while our ASML revenue estimates grow 22%/24% in € terms (and c.27%/24% in \$ terms) in our base case 12M PT scenario

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

AI demand upside increasingly supported by datapoints: The durability of AI related demand beyond 2026 remains a key investor debate. That said, recent evidence around AI adoption and infrastructure demand has somewhat alleviated concerns in our view. As such, our confidence in the benefit accruing to ASML from AI market growth has improved compared with a few quarters ago, and we continue to see scope for further positive revisions to expectations.

- We note that recent commentary from **US Hyperscalers points towards a strong AI demand environment** following the introduction of AI agents in recent months. For example, **Google** at its 1Q26 results stated that its **AI revenues increased 63% yoy** and the **company doubled its backlog qoq to \$460bn**. Further, Amazon highlighted that its **AWS revenues grew 28% yoy** (which is the fastest pace in last 15 quarters) with **AI related revenues growing triple digit yoy**.
- Further, Hyperscalers also emphasised that **AI infrastructure supply demand conditions remain very tight** and, consequently, have **upgraded 2026 capex plans**.

As such, **Alphabet** now expects 2026 capex of \$180-190bn (vs. \$175-185bn previously), reflecting incremental investments, including the Intersect Power acquisition. Importantly, management also **guided to materially higher capex in 2027 versus 2026**, driven by sustained AI demand and helping to ease concerns around a potential capex peak in 2026 in our view.

- As such, our US Internet and Software teams now expect **Hyperscaler capex to reach \$918bn/\$1.02trn and implying growth of 28%/11% yoy in 2027/28** relative to capex of \$720bn in 2026 which reflects a material acceleration relative to prior expectations.

Exhibit 2: 1QCY26 Hyperscaler results underscored the requirements for significant AI infrastructure buildout to support strong AI adoption

	Recent Hyperscaler commentary points towards accelerating AI demand and compute infrastructure buildout
Alphabet	• Cloud revenues accelerated 63% yoy, and reported backlog increased c.2x qoq to \$460bn • Raised its guide for 2026 capex to \$180-190bn (vs \$175-185bn prior); expects 2027 capex to increase significantly yoy
Amazon	• AWS revenues increased 28% yoy implying a \$150bn ARR with AI related revenues growing triple digits % yoy • AMZN disclosed revenue commitments of >\$225bn for its custom silicon chips; reiterated elevated capex in 2026
Microsoft	• AI business exceeded \$37bn ARR growing 123% yoy with seat addition for MSFT 365 copilot accelerating 250% yoy • Expects to remain capacity constrained in 2026; plans to invest \$190bn in CY26 implying material hoh spending uplift
Meta	• Expects elevated capex intensity with 2026 capex guidance raised to \$125-145bn (vs \$115-135bn prior)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

- Furthermore, this strength is echoed across the AI semiconductor ecosystem as **leading-edge Logic/Foundry and memory players continue to highlight tight supply demand dynamics** driven by **AI applications**. For example, **TSMC** highlighted at its 1Q26 results that it **continues to see a very tight supply demand gap for leading-edge semis chips** used in AI applications, and the company is stepping up investments to bring capacity online. On the **memory** side, our colleagues in Asia highlighted that TrendForce slightly raised its forecasts for 2Q26 PC DRAM and server DRAM pricing. Finally, **Samsung** noted that **fulfillment rates remain at historically low levels**, driving **customers to pull forward 2027 demand** and implying **further widening of the supply demand gap into 2027**.

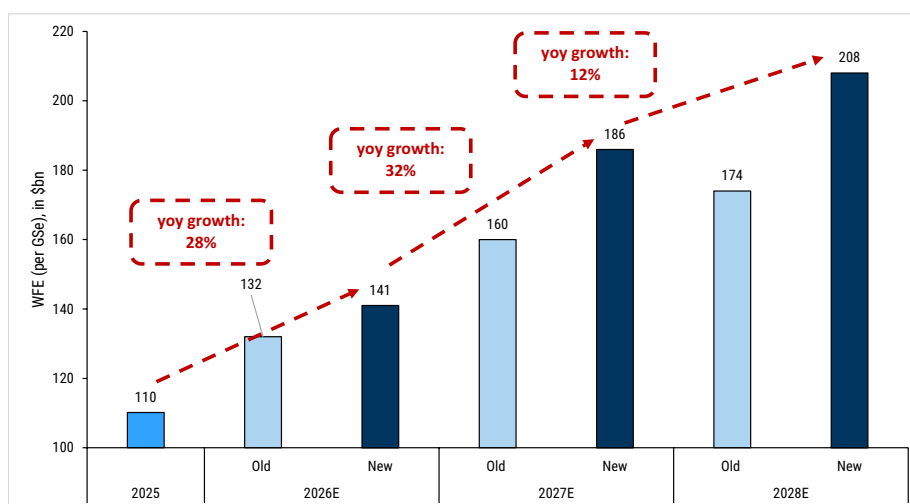
Exhibit 3: Recent datapoints suggest accelerating AI demand driving a tight supply demand environment for leading-edge Logic/Memory chips

	Positive Capex Revisions and Datapoints Across the Ecosystem
TSMC	Continues to see robust demand for leading-edge chips driven by HPC and AI Expects 2026 capex towards the upper end of its \$52-56bn guidance
Hynix	Memory supply shortages have resulted in customers placing higher amounts of mid-to-long term orders Reiterated guidance to significantly increase capex yoy
Samsung	S/D dynamics remain acute, with constraints intensifying as industry capacity expansion stays limited Samsung is already discussing demand for 2027 with its major customers
Sandisk	Guided 2Q26 revenue of \$8.0bn which came in far above consensus estimate of \$6.97bn SNDK expects NAND to remain increasingly supply constrained in CY26 and beyond due to supply side prudence
Nvidia	Expects Data Center revenues of >\$1trn through 2027 driven by both compute and networking demand
AMD	Expects CPU TAM of \$120bn by 2030 implying CAGR of 35% (vs CAGR of 18% prior) Seeing signs of significant acceleration in demand from rapid scaling of Enterprise/Cloud AI workloads

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

- Additionally, recent datapoints also point to longer term AI driven demand tailwinds, improving visibility on capacity expansion plans across the ecosystem. As we have previously discussed, the **Terafab initiative**, for example, **represents a large scale positive for long term demand** across leading edge semiconductors and capital equipment suppliers (see more details [here](#)).
- More broadly, our [US semis](#) team recently upgraded its WFE estimates and now expect **WFE spend of \$141bn/\$186bn (in 2026/2027) implying 28%/32% yoy growth** (vs previous estimates of \$132bn/\$160bn implying 20%/21% yoy growth prior) driven by **robust investments in Memory (both advanced and conventional) as well as leading-edge Logic/Foundry**. As such, this compares versus our estimates of +22%/24% in € terms (and c.27%/24% in \$ terms) growth for ASML's revenue estimates in 2026/27 in our 12M PT case.

Exhibit 4: Our US semis team positively revised its WFE spending estimates reflecting a higher Foundry and Memory related spend



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

- In this vein, our current estimates assume a **high 20s% AI contribution to ASML's EUV revenues by 2027** (vs. mid 20s% previously), compared with a mid 20s% contribution we estimate is implied by the current share price. Our 12 month price target implies a \$186bn WFE market in 2027, consistent with US semiconductor team's forecast, while our bull case implies a larger WFE market to service stronger than expected AI demand.
- Overall, while we initially saw a positive trajectory for AI demand and scope for upside in our AI deepdive note from November 2025, recent proof points have increased our confidence that this spending will translate into lithography demand for ASML, and we continue to see scope for upside here. In our **bull case scenario**, we assume a **stronger AI driven lithography demand, lifting AI's share of EUV revenues to the mid 30s% by 2027**.
- As such, we estimate that **AI demand contributes c.40%/50% of incremental EUV tool demand across 2025-27** in our base/bull case scenarios, respectively, albeit we believe that this share could grow in the scenario where leading-edge Logic/Memory players prioritise AI related demand over other end markets.

China revenue expectations appear conservative: China revenue sustainability remains a key topic of investor focus, given potential for incremental export restrictions, but we believe company's targets are achievable.

- While **ASML** continues to **guide to c.20% China revenue share in 2026**, we believe the **market more than discounts this outcome** potentially due to risks from incremental export restrictions. That said, the current expectations of **China revenues appear conservative in our view**, particularly in light of more constructive demand commentary from peers. **KLA**, for instance, **expects China revenues to be flat to slightly up yoy**, while **ASM International continues to guide to yoy growth** driven by mature logic/foundry demand.
- As such, we estimate that our **12M PT continues to reflect c.19% of sales from**

China in 2027 (as shown in [Exhibit 1](#)) which is slightly below the top end of the historical contribution range of 15–20% and compares to guidance for 20% of sales in 2026. As such, we believe that the current share price bakes in only 18% China share of revenues in 2027. Further we highlight that our bear case/bull case scenarios embed China revenue share of 17%/20% (vs 15%/21% prior) in 2027.

- Separately, while we acknowledge scope for regulatory changes in China, we note that ASML's current guide for 20% revenue share from China in 2026 already embeds any implications from an expansion of export restrictions going forward thus reducing downside risk in our view. Finally, we continue to see scope for Chinese lower end memory players to want to participate in the memory strength in western markets and hence spend more than expected.

Exhibit 5: We believe that ASML's outlook for China could be overly conservative given the recent positive commentary semicap peers

	Recent datapoints suggest a more resilient than expected demand from China
KLA	China WFE market to be flat to slightly up in CY26, and China revenue contribution to be mid-to-high 20s %
LAM	The company expects China WFE to be roughly flat in 2026
ASMI	Reiterated expectations for yoy growth in China revenues , driven by mature Logic/Foundry segment
BESI	Stated that China demand remains robust due to continued expansion in advanced packaging capacity

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Customer market structure inefficiency remains underappreciated: We continue to view manufacturing inefficiency related to market structure as an important and underappreciated variable for ASML.

- Recent **progress by Samsung** in **advancing leading edge logic nodes and onboarding customers** suggests **scope for a broader set of scaled customers beyond TSMC**. We see this as incrementally positive for ASML, as multiple globally distributed leading edge fabs drive higher aggregate wafer start requirements. For example, **Samsung** recently stated that it **expects to get more customer wins for its 2nm process in the near future**, and the company is in **preliminary review phase to build a 2nd fab in Taylor, TX, USA**. Further, the company at its 1Q26 results highlighted that it anticipates a material increase in equipment expenditures as it progresses with deployment of new capacity.
- Our **estimates continue to embed a c.HSD % incremental demand due to manufacturing efficiencies** versus the current stock price which appears to bake in c. 7% incremental demand (as shown in [Exhibit 1](#)) which would arise when multiple chip manufacturers would expand production in diverse geographies, and we see the recent progress made by Samsung as positive in this regard.

- We highlight that our estimates for inefficiency embedded in our 12M PT are towards the top end of ASML's guide of 5-8% incremental wafer demand by the end of the decade, whereas in our bear case we assume capacity additions by other leading-edge players imply a modest 5% incremental wafer starts in 2027. We believe that the market is currently pricing in an inefficiency factor which could be too conservative, and we see scope for upside to these metrics in the coming quarters as further proofpoints emerge.

EUV layer growth also remains a key investor focus: We believe the share price still does not fully reflect the expected inflection in EUV Lithography layer growth as the industry moves beyond the FinFET to GAA transition and re-accelerates node shrinkage.

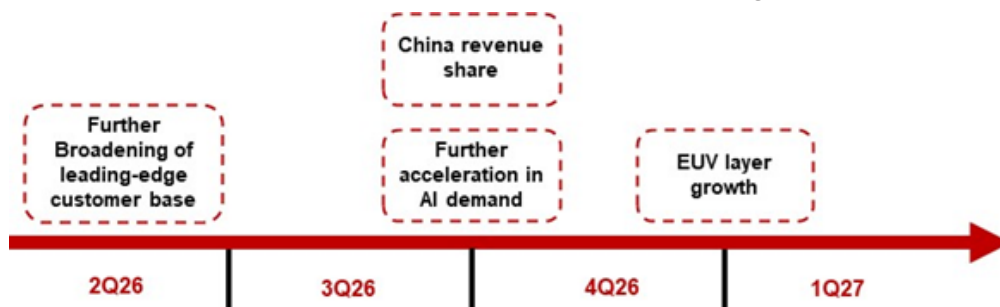
- Consistent with our prior views we believe that the **stock price does not yet capture a meaningful expansion in EUV layers** that we expect to happen as the **semis industry starts to move beyond the current architectural transition** (i.e. from FinFET to Gate-All-Around) and **refocuses on driving node shrinkage**.
- Further, we highlight that in our published 12M price target, we assume **EUV layer count of 24** (low NA equivalent and assuming one High NA layer is equivalent to two Low NA layers which in line with ASML's commentary from its 2024 CMD) in 2027 (vs 25 prior) for Logic applications **which reflects in our positive view on EUV insertion**, albeit we **slightly reduce our assumption around High NA layers to reflect cautious commentary around High NA adoption timelines** from one of ASML's key customer.
- That said, we continue to believe that **High NA tools will be adopted by all of ASML's key customers** given these tools offer **material improvements in various performance metrics** versus the existing Low NA EUV tools.
- More broadly, we reiterate our assumption of 22/23/25 EUV layers in the bear scenario valuation/current share price/bull scenario valuation. This can be seen in the context of ASML's guidance of 25-30 layers by 2030.
- While we believe some investors have been concerned about high NA adoption timelines of a key customer towards the end of the decade, we continue to argue that at HVM manufacturing scale a lower degree of high NA would be compensated at revenue level by more low NA EUV machines which would be margin accretive and hence actually result in higher EPS in that time frame (2029).

While a number of key catalysts have materialised for ASML in recent months, we continue to see multiple levers that could pose upside risk to investor expectations and valuation

We note **positive updates on multiple catalysts central to our ASML thesis in recent months** (such as TSMC raising its AI revenue expectations and datapoints around a broadening customer base). That said, **we remain constructive on the potential catalyst path for ASML in the coming quarters** and believe that commentary around these would be taken positively by investors given the current share price continues to embed only modest upside from these variables (as discussed above).

- First, we note positive revisions in recent months to expectations for China demand for **multiple front-end semicap players on China revenue in 2026**. That said, we highlight that **ASML continues to expect its China revenue share to decline in 2026** (based on its c.20% revenue share expectations). As such, we **see scope for positive revisions in the coming quarters** given the **strong underlying demand trends in the region** in tandem with the fact that it has positively surprised on demand in recent years.
- Additionally, we believe that the **transition to GAA will be broadly complete by the end of 2026**, and expect updates around **technological roadmaps for incremental node shrinkage for leading-edge Logic players** which would be a leading indicator pointing towards an inflection in Lithography layer growth going forward.
- Further, we believe that there is scope for **further positive commentary on a broadening leading-edge Logic customer base** as players which have historically lagged in the space get more design wins.
- Finally, we note that the spending on AI has surprised on the upside in recent quarters, and **we will look for updates on compute infrastructure S/D** which could pose further upside risk to our base case 12M PT and estimates in the event of an acceleration of AI adoption by Enterprises. We believe agentic AI could lead to further upside, for example as a result of driving further CPU and HBM needs.

Exhibit 6: Continue to see multiple catalysts for ASML in the coming quarters



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Changes to estimates

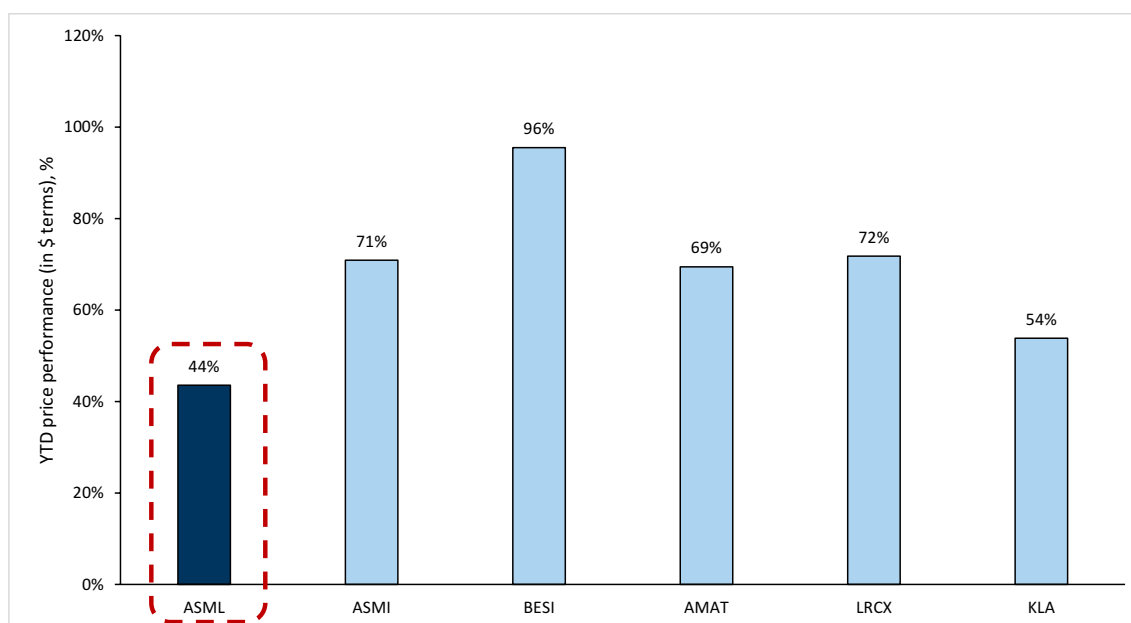
We keep our FY26 revenue estimates unchanged but raise our FY27-28 topline estimates by c.1% to reflect our more positive outlook for EUV Low NA tools partially offset by a

slightly more conservative near term view on the cadence of High NA shipments. That said, our revenue estimates across the outer years remain unchanged as we remain confident in continued EUV revenue growth across memory and logic. Further, our FY26-30 gross profit estimates are higher between 0-1%, reflecting changes to the topline and benefits from a margin accretive product mix. Our FY26-30 EBIT estimates are higher between 0-2% due to our latest topline and GM estimates. Finally, our EPS forecasts change by 0% to +2% (factoring in our EBIT and share count assumptions).

Valuation remains undemanding relative to improving growth outlook indexed to the structural demand and stronger competitive moat

- While the **shares are up c.45% YTD abs** (in \$ terms), we highlight that the shares have **materially underperformed the EU Tech Hardware in aggregate which is up c.+60% YTD** (in \$ terms). Additionally, we note that **ASML has underperformed its global semicap peers YTD** (in \$ terms) with ASMI/BESI/AMAT/LAM/KLA up c.+70%/95%/70%/70%/55% respectively.

Exhibit 7: While ASML is up +44% YTD, it has significantly underperformed its semicap peers which in our view is unwarranted



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Eikon Datastream

- As such, our updated 12 month price target of **€1,600 is based on a CY27E P/E multiple of 37x (unchanged)**, implying a **valuation premium of c.10% which is below the five year median versus global peers of c.20%**. However, the **shares currently trade a slight discount to its global peers implying a discount in-line with the 10th percentile of the 5Y historical range**, which we view as unjustified given ASML's AI exposure, relatively de-risked China outlook, and strengthening competitive moat with an increasing share of EUV revenues (where ASML has a monopolistic market position).

- We highlight that our **€2,000 bull case valuation implies a premium near the 60th percentile—still undemanding in our view**, given scope for **incremental upside from AI**, continued **supply demand tightness for leading-edge Logic/Memory chips** which improves forward-looking ASML's visibility, **more resilient China revenues** with higher gross margins, and an eventual inflection in EUV lithography layer growth (with ASML becoming more monopolistic in the Lithography space as EUV grows in the mix).
- More broadly, we continue to view ASML as our preferred near-term AI exposure within European semicap, driven by its leading edge logic and memory positioning and limited exposure to lower visibility trailing edge nodes.

Valuation and key risks

We are Buy rated on ASML with a 12-month price target of €1,600 (vs €1,570 prior) based on a 37x CY27 P/E multiple (unchanged) applied to our higher EPS estimates. Key risks to our view and price target include EUV delays, capex cyclicality and unfavourable market share shifts.

ASML.AS	12m Price Target: €1,600.00	Price: €1,265.80	Upside: 26.4%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: €486.6bn / \$571.1bn Enterprise value: €469.3bn / \$550.8bn 3m ADTV: €882.4mn / \$1.0bn Netherlands European Semiconductors, Hardware and Gaming Tech M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (€ mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (€ mn) Old	32,667.3	39,815.5	49,539.3	54,873.5
	EBIT (€ mn)	11,301.5	14,290.0	19,914.8	23,266.4
	EPS (€) New	24.16	30.97	43.39	51.08
	EPS (€) Old	24.16	30.98	42.73	50.30
	EV/sales (X)	8.3	11.8	9.1	8.0
	EV/EBITDA (X)	22.0	30.6	21.5	18.0
	P/E (X)	30.0	40.9	29.2	24.8
	Org. sales grth (%)	–	–	–	–
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (€)	6.88	6.60	7.37	10.13

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 12 May 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Alexander Duval, Anant Jakhar and Ayo Odunaiya, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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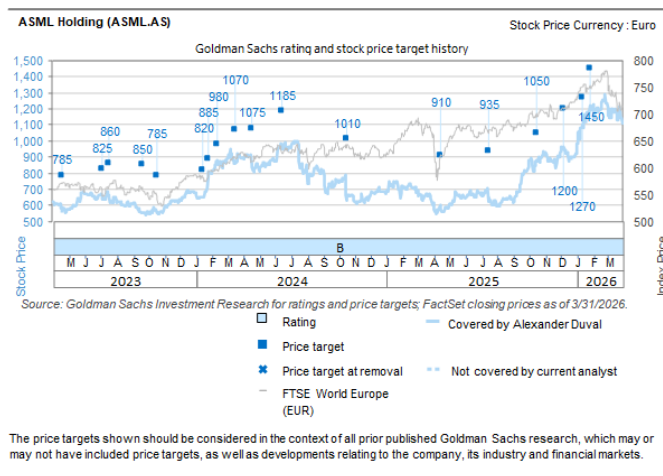
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Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	60%	45%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

ASML Holding (ASML.AS)

Date of report Target price (€) Closing price (€)

16-Apr-26	1,570.00	1,222.60
29-Jan-26	1,450.00	1,192.00
12-Jan-26	1,270.00	1,086.40
08-Dec-25	1,200.00	963.20
16-Oct-25	1,050.00	877.40
17-Jul-25	935.00	650.20
16-Apr-25	910.00	574.00
16-Oct-24	1,010.00	633.90
14-Jun-24	1,185.00	953.00
17-Apr-24	1,075.00	852.40
18-Mar-24	1,070.00	870.80
12-Feb-24	980.00	877.60
24-Jan-24	885.00	775.80
15-Jan-24	820.00	648.20
18-Oct-23	785.00	553.20
20-Sep-23	850.00	556.60
19-Jul-23	860.00	651.90
05-Jul-23	825.00	659.30

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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